

BANGALORE | Three For Joy

Migrants from the Janata Dal parivar had the last laugh after they clinched three top posts in the Karnataka Congress. And the one to be jumping with joy is Kuruba (shepherd) community leader Siddaramaiah who was crowned the Opposition leader in the 224-strong Karnataka Assembly last week. He filled the vacancy created by Mallikarjuna Kharge, a nine-time MLA who won the Gulbarga Lok Sabha seat and was promoted to Union minister for labour and employment. "Good wishes to him. He came with 10 leaders and now he has become the head of a hundred leaders," Kharge said of his successor. Siddaramaiah was rewarded within three years of being in the Congress after dumping the JD(s). State Congress unit chief R.V. Deshpande and state youth Congress President Krishna Byre Gowda also were with the JD(s) earlier.

by Stephen David



SIDDARAMAIAH

PATNA | Post-Poll Regression

Change seems to be the only constant in Lok Janshakti Party (LJP) chief Ram Vilas Paswan's political career. After his Man Friday and solitary LJP member of the Bihar Legislative Council Sanjay Singh recently joined

Nitish Kumar, many of his lieutenants have been questioning the rationale behind an electoral tie-up with Lalu Prasad Yadav's Rashtriya Janata Dal (RJD). Paswan, who was in Bihar recently, has had to face a good number of lieutenants openly suggesting that the LJP could have done better had it gone alone in the Lok Sabha polls. Paswan, however, still insists that the LJP-RJD alliance would continue in Bihar. Rumours are rife that Paswan perhaps wants a Rajya Sabha nomination for which Lalu Prasad Yadav's support will be needed.

by Amitabh Srivastava



PASWAN

Stop Over

The government-owned Centaur hotel near Delhi airport functions as a transit camp for new organisations without a roof over their heads. It earlier housed the National Disaster Management Agency and now the National Investigation Agency.

DELHI | Precious Prisoner

India's Silicon Valley may be turning into a haven for North-eastern rebel groups. Last week, the Assam Police, backed by the National Investigation Agency (NIA), arrested Jewel Garlossa aka Mihir Burman, the commander-in-chief of the notorious Dima Halam Daogah (DHD) militant group from the garden city. Jewel, one of the most wanted North-eastern militants, had been living in a rented apartment in Bangalore since March this year. He had obtained a fake driving licence and was even a regular at a neighbourhood gymnasium. Meanwhile, his faction, the DHD, killed 27 people in 14 attacks in April. All these were being remote-controlled by Jewel in Bangalore. So why Bangalore for Jewel? "A lax attitude by the local police and the ease of obtaining residence without the mandatory background checks makes it attractive for rebels," says a senior army official. In the past two years, military intelligence in the city has made at least three separate arrests, rounding up leaders of groups like UNLF and PREPAK.

by Sandeep Unnithan



GARLOSSA